

aking by:

- Ensuring that Compliance Standards are current, easy to find, and widely available to team members;
- Monitoring the regulatory landscape for developments and updating our policies, as necessary, to maintain compliance with applicable laws and regulations;
- Educating our team members on our policies and reporting avenues through training, awareness initiatives, and other outreach efforts;
- Providing guidance and resolving related inquiries involving, for example, conflicts of interests and gifts and entertainment; and,
- Encouraging and facilitating appropriate risk assessment, due diligence, and remediation to deter, detect, and address unlawful, unethical, and discriminatory conduct.

Board Oversight

The Board, through its Audit Committee, is responsible for administering the Code of Conduct, and for addressing material issues and risks concerning Compliance Standards and applicable laws and regulations. The Audit Committee has delegated day-to-day responsibility for administering and interpreting the Code of Conduct to GitLab's Chief Legal Officer.

Team Member Responsibilities

Each team member is responsible for reading, understanding, and ultimately complying with GitLab's Compliance Standards. Team members are expected to deal honestly, ethically, and fairly with customers, partners, suppliers, competitors, and other third parties. GitLab expressly prohibits team members from violating applicable laws and regulations, and any team member who does so may face disciplinary action, up to and including dismissal (subject to local law). To memorialize and reinforce GitLab's expectations, we require each team member to review and acknowledge our Code of Conduct on an annual basis.

Team members are educated on GitLab's policies and procedures and related laws and regulations through continuous training, both at onboarding and throughout the year, and awareness campaigns. Team members are encouraged to ask questions about our policies and seek guidance when necessary through various avenues, including a Slack channel dedicated to ethics and compliance.

Reporting of Concerns and Violations

GitLab strives to foster a work environment in which ethical issues and concerns may be raised and discussed with supervisors or others without fear of retribution. If a team member becomes aware of a suspected or actual violation of law, regulation, or GitLab Compliance Standards, they have a responsibility to promptly report their concern in accordance with GitLab's Whistleblower Policy and Code of Conduct.

GitLab offers team members a variety of ways to report suspected or actual violations. Team members may raise their concerns orally or in writing to their direct supervisor or manager, to GitLab's Chief Legal Officer, or to the Audit Committee.

At any time, team members may also submit reports using EthicsPoint, a GitLab-provided tool that is available 24 hours a day and allows for anonymous reporting about conduct addressed in

the Code of Business Conduct and Ethics. Reports to EthicsPoint can be submitted using a toll-free hotline or through the EthicsPoint website. In addition to EthicsPoint, GitLab has engaged Lighthouse Services to provide an anonymous hotline for team members to submit reports involving team member relations.

GitLab treats all reports seriously. Notification of reports submitted via EthicsPoint is automatically provided to the Chief Legal Officer and Chairperson of the Audit Committee and those reports are promptly and thoroughly investigated by qualified personnel at the direction of the Chief Legal Officer, as appropriate. Reports involving team member relations are reported to the People Group team.

Partner Ethics

GitLab's commitment to legal and ethical conduct extends to its suppliers, contractors, resellers, agents, and consultants (collectively, "Partners"). GitLab expects all Partners, their employees, sub-suppliers, and any other party involved in the execution of GitLab work to comply with all applicable laws, regulations, and the standards set forth in GitLab's Partner Code of Ethics, which includes standards relating to ethical conduct, including human rights and labor, health and safety, bribery and corruption, environmental impacts, and more.

Appendix

- GRI disclosures
- SASB disclosures
- TCFD disclosures
- Performance Data Tables

Contact

For questions regarding GitLab's ESG report and data, please contact <ESG@GitLab.com>.

Forward-Looking Statements

This report contains forward-looking statements within the meaning of the federal securities laws. These statements involve assumptions and are subject to known and unknown risks and uncertainties that could cause actual results to differ materially from those discussed or anticipated. For a complete discussion of risk associated with these forward-looking statements in our business, please refer to our SEC filings, including our most recent quarterly report on Form 10-Q and our most recent annual report on Form 10-K.

Our forward-looking statements are based upon information currently available to us. We caution you to not place undue reliance on forward-looking statements, and we undertake no duty or obligation to update or revise any forward-looking statement, or to report any future events, or circumstances or to reflect the occurrence of unanticipated events.

Additionally, this presentation contains information related to upcoming features and functionality. It is important to note that the information presented is for informational purposes only, so please do not rely on the information for purchasing or planning purposes. Just like with all projects, the items mentioned during the presentation are subject to change or delay, and the development, release, and timing of any products, features or functionality

remain at the sole discretion of GitLab.

Previous ESG Reports

- FY23 ESG Report

SECTION: company/family-and-friends-day.md

What is a Family and Friends Day?

We started our Family & Friends day benefit in early 2020 to help team members cope with the COVID-19 pandemic. We planned to continue Family & Friends days for as long as the majority of the world was dealing with the pandemic. While the World Health Organization declared an end to the COVID-19 global health emergency in early 2023, we have maintained Family & Friends days as a team member benefit with different iterations each fiscal year.

Team members are encouraged to share about their Family and Friends day in the family-and-friends-day Slack channel after the event, or publicly on social media such as Twitter, LinkedIn, or wherever they're most comfortable using the hashtag FamilyFriends1st. Sharing is optional. Taking the day off is strongly encouraged if your role allows it.

FY'26 Family and Friends Days

In FY25, we chose one day a quarter to recognize a Family & Friends day. In FY26, we plan to consolidate those 4 Family & Friends days near the end of the calendar year. Keeping our Friends & Family day benefit at a time when our customers are often away from work, and during a quieter time in the year, will allow us to best serve our customers and meet our business objectives.

The proposed dates for FY26 Family & Friends days are:

1. 2025-12-26
1. 2025-12-29
1. 2025-12-30
1. 2025-12-31

Family & Friends days will be automatically loaded into Workday by end of Q1FY26, for all team members, so there's no need for team members to enter them manually.

In countries where a Family & Friends day falls on a public holiday, team members are encouraged to utilize their public holiday on another day, keeping in mind that the public holiday accrual balance needs to be used within the same calendar year.

For example, if the Family & Friends day on 2025-12-26 is a public holiday in your country, create a new absence request in Workday for the public holiday on another day within the same calendar year, such as 2025-12-24, by selecting Type of Absence > Time Offs > Public Holiday, and add a note that you are using your public holiday on this day because 2025-12-26 is a public holiday in your location which falls on one of GitLab's Family & Friends days.

- In Israel, Family & Friends days will be adjusted to 2025-12-28, 2025-12-29, 2025-12-30, and 2025-12-31.

As with years past, team members in roles that require them to work on a date designated as a Family & Friends day can work with their manager to find an alternative day. Team members in roles that require them to work on a date designated as a Family & Friends day will be able to request the alternative(s) day in Workday (or via the Workday link in Slack).

- Choose a day that works best for your manager and your team. Please note: The alternative date should be within 30 days (before or after) of the scheduled Family & Friends day.
- Log into Workday and request time off using the category "Time Off in Lieu", reason "Family and Friends Day".
- In the comments section, please note: "In lieu of Family and Friends Day on XXX".
- This will route to your manager for approval.

Contact the Absence Management team via HelpLab (People > Absence menu) if you need further assistance or have questions.

FY'25 Family and Friends Days

In FY'25, the dates for Family & Friends Day were:

1. 2024-04-05
1. 2024-06-14
1. 2024-09-13
1. 2024-12-23

FY'24 Family and Friends Days

1. 2023-09-22
1. 2023-10-06
1. 2023-11-27
1. 2023-12-29
1. 2024-01-12

We will look at scheduling future dates pending the global COVID-19 situation. Because we are living in unprecedented times and are trying to give our Team Members some extra space in their lives outside of work. In line with our Paid Time Off policy, we encourage GitLab Team Members to continue to take additional days off, as needed. Family and Friends Day is a reminder to do this.

Past Family and Friends Days

Family and Friends Days have been held on these dates:

1. 2020-05-01
1. 2020-06-12
1. 2020-08-14
1. 2020-10-09
1. 2020-11-25

1. 2020-12-18
1. 2021-01-15
1. 2021-02-26
1. 2021-03-19
1. 2021-04-16
1. 2021-05-28
1. 2021-06-25
1. 2021-07-16
1. 2021-08-27
1. 2021-09-24
1. 2021-10-15
1. 2021-11-29
1. 2021-12-27
1. 2022-01-03
1. 2022-02-25
1. 2022-03-25
1. 2022-04-11
1. 2022-05-27
1. 2022-06-24
1. 2022-07-11
1. 2022-08-29
1. 2022-09-26
1. 2022-10-07
1. 2022-11-18
1. 2022-12-30
1. 2023-01-13
1. 2023-02-27
1. 2023-03-24
1. 2023-04-17
1. 2023-05-26
1. 2023-06-23
1. 2023-07-03
1. 2023-08-25

FAQ about Family and Friends Day

Who determines upcoming Family and Friends Days?

Any GitLab team member is able to propose a Family and Friends Day. If there are no proposals from a GitLab Team Member, the Total Rewards Team will propose a day for E-group approval. To propose a Family and Friends Day please follow the steps outlined below:

1. Review the GitLab Team Meetings calendar for major conflicts, review major holidays, and avoid the end of the quarter to ensure our Sales team can participate before determining a date proposal.
1. Submit a merge request to modify the Upcoming Family and Friends Days section of this page with the date of your Family and Friends Day proposal.
1. Post the MR in the e-group Slack channel and @mention the @exec-group and @exec-admins for feedback.
1. If feedback is positive, assign the MR to our Chief People Officer, Wendy Barnes.

1. Once the Merge Request is approved, the Total Rewards team will announce the Family & Friends day on the whats-happening-at-gitlab Slack Channel. The Total Rewards team will post upcoming Family and Friends Days on the GitLab Team Meeting Google calendar.

I'm in a role which requires me to work that day. How can I still benefit from this initiative?

If you are in a role that requires you to work or your team has other coverage requirements on Family and Friends Day (for example, Customer Support), you can work with your manager to find an alternative day. We encourage you to consider the following business day as the preferred second choice for a day away, but do what works best for you and your team.

What if the date is a public holiday or non-working day in my country? How does this apply to me?

We encourage you to take off the next working day. If this day isn't an option, work with your manager to find another day that works for you and your team.

How is this any different than our vacation policy?

Nothing about our Paid Time Off policy is changing. We wanted to designate a specific day in order to more proactively force a pause for team members. If most of the company isn't working, there is less pressure for you to do so.

What about client or prospect meetings that conflict?

If you feel that this meeting can be rescheduled without any setbacks to the business, please go ahead and do so. If you have a meeting that would be hard to reschedule or would jeopardize the business results, please work with your manager to find another day that would work for both you and your team.

What if I'm out sick on either of those days?

Feel better! Please work with your manager to find another day that works for you and your team.

Can I choose to take a different day off for Family and Friends Day that is more convenient for me?

Unless in circumstances described above (e.g., role requires you to work on a Family and Friends Day, the designated day falls on a non-working day), team members that want to benefit from Family and Friends Day should take the designated day off. This provides different benefits from a regular PTO day.

If you'd like to take a different day off for personal reasons, refer to the Paid Time Off policy.

How do I communicate that I'm off that day?

We'll assume that most people are off on Family and Friends Day, but we know that some people

will take other days.

Please enter the date in Workday by selecting the Family and Friends Day option in the Time Offs drop down list.

Feel free to block your calendar with "Family and Friends Day" to share whatever day you take.

SECTION: company/faq-gitlab-licensing-technology-to-independent-chinese-company.md

Overview

GitLab announced that it has licensed its technology to a new, independent Chinese company. The independent company will help drive adoption of the GitLab complete DevOps platform in China and foster the GitLab community and open source contributions.

Q. Will existing China reseller and systems integrator customers move to JiHu?

At this time, JiHu has just formed, and currently is not offering any product solutions. Users in the local market in China will be informed as soon as JiHu launches product offerings.

Q. Will JiHu have a different terms of service and customer acceptance policy than GitLab Inc.?

JiHu is an independent company and will set up their own terms of service and customer acceptance policy. They do not have any obligation to follow GitLab Inc.'s terms of service or policies.

Q. Has GitLab Inc. coordinated with the Chinese government to establish the new company?

No, GitLab Inc. has not been working with the Chinese government. JiHu has been working with the Chinese government independently to file the required paperwork to become an official company in China and secure the appropriate licensing for the SaaS business, as required.

Q. How will intellectual property work between GitLab Inc. and JiHu?

There will be three distributions of the GitLab product: CE (Community Edition), EE (Enterprise Edition), and JH (JiHu Edition). The CE distribution will continue to be available globally. The EE distribution will only be sold outside China. The JH distribution will only be sold in China.

GitLab and JiHu will use two separate repositories where GitLab's repository will be upstream and JiHu's repository will be downstream. Changes to GitLab CE and EE will be one-way mirrored to the JiHu Edition, however, changes to the JiHu Edition will not be mirrored back to GitLab CE and EE.

Instead of mirroring, JiHu will be able to contribute to the Community Edition and Enterprise Edition by following the same meticulous protocols we already have in place for our current contributors. Each contribution must meet GitLab's rigorous standards for security and code quality before being added to the GitLab application.

As an independent company, JiHu will manage its own technologies and infrastructure. JiHu's SaaS service (GitLab.cn) and GitLab Inc.'s SaaS service (GitLab.com) will share no common infrastructure, networking connectivity, systems, services, data, or resources.

Q. Will JiHu contribute code back to GitLab? How will GitLab Inc. protect the code base from potential malicious intent?

There will be three distributions of the GitLab product: CE (Community Edition), EE (Enterprise Edition), and JH (JiHu Edition). There are two separate and distinct code repositories: One containing only the CE and EE distributions and another uni-directionally mirrored repository containing CE, EE, and the JH distribution.

The CE distribution will continue to be offered as FOSS (free open source software).

The EE distribution will be offered to customers outside of China and will not contain the JH distribution's generally contributed features or code. All incremental contributions from JiHu to CE and EE will be upstreamed as merge requests to GitLab Inc.'s maintainers for enhanced security review prior to acceptance.

The JH distribution will only be offered to customers inside China.

GitLab's code is source-available and the open source components of GitLab are published under an MIT open source license. Like the hundreds of contributions we receive each month from our global community, JiHu will contribute to GitLab CE and EE following the same meticulous protocols we already have in place. Each contribution must meet our rigorous standards for security and code quality before being added to the GitLab application. GitLab Inc. is the maintainer of CE and EE and is solely able to approve merge requests into CE and EE following our software supply chain security procedures. GitLab Inc. will retain full merge rights and control over everything that goes into CE and EE.

GitLab Inc. has also instituted additional code audit and security oversight for code contributed by JiHu and the open source community in China to ensure both quality and security. We will follow existing processes for security reviews for externally contributed code, with a focus on code functionality that includes any of the following: processing credentials/tokens, storing credentials/tokens, logic for privilege escalation, authorization logic, user/account access controls, and authentication mechanisms. The GitLab Inc. Security team will continue to work with our Developer Relations team to ensure that security reviews are conducted according to our established standards.

Q. How will GitLab prevent supply chain attacks?

GitLab is able to provide added stringent safeguards for our customers by increasing our deliberate security protections and ensuring additional degrees of separation between GitLab and JiHu. To protect the integrity of the GitLab brand and to ensure the security of our software product and prevent supply chain attacks, we have made a thoughtful decision to license our technology to an entirely independent and local China-based company that enables us to institute even stronger separation between our customers in various markets as well as within our development and hosting environments.

GitLab's code is source-available and the open source components of GitLab are published under an MIT open source license. GitLab code contribution processes have been specifically developed to identify and protect against malicious code and supply chain attacks. There are a multitude of controls in place today that already help us detect and prevent a supply chain attack on the GitLab application, including: code review, table top exercises, pre- and post-deployment security assessments/tests, continual testing of GitLab Inc.'s cloud environment, and various detection and alerting technologies. We continue to invest in best-in-class processes as the industry evolves to retain strong controls on contributor identities and bolster our security practices. In addition, GitLab Inc.'s Red Team routinely performs specific exercises simulating supply chain attacks to validate and improve on all controls. We work closely with bounty programs, as well as security assessment and penetration testing firms to ensure external review of our security posture.

SECTION: company/gitlab-all-company-meetings.md

Overview

GitLab has three big quarterly internal-only meetings to align team members on key happenings and priorities across the business. The first is the Quarterly Kickoff, the next is the Post-Earnings Recap & AMA, and the last is Assembly. This page provides an overview of each of these.

Timing

Timing of team member touchpoints:

- Quarterly Kickoff (first half of the first month of the quarter): Typically a video update from GitLab's CEO shared on Slack, followed by an AMA
- Earnings Call (first half of the second month of the quarter): Public call that team members are invited to attend
- Post-Earnings Recap & AMA (immediately following earnings): A 25 minute private AMA occurring after Earnings
- Assembly (end of second month, early the third month of a quarter): An all-company meeting occurring 3-4 weeks after Earnings that covers a wide range of topics

Team Member Meeting Recordings

Recordings and agendas (internal only) listed in reverse chronological order.

Date	Recording	AMA Agenda	
-----	-----	-----	
2024-10-03	FY25-Q3 GitLab Assembly	AMA	
2024-09-05	FY25-Q2 Post-earnings internal recap	AMA	
2024-08-12	FY25-Q3 Quarterly Kickoff	AMA	
2024-06-18	FY25-Q2 GitLab Assembly	AMA	
2024-06-05	FY25-Q1 Post-earnings internal recap	AMA	
2024-05-13	FY25-Q2 Quarterly Kickoff	AMA	
2024-03-07	FY24-Q4 Post-earnings internal recap	AMA	

2024-02-14	FY25-Q1 Quarterly Kickoff	AMA
2023-12-07	FY24-Q3 Post-earnings internal recap	AMA
2023-11-16	FY24-Q4 Quarterly Kickoff	AMA
2023-10-04	FY24-Q3 GitLab Assembly	AMA
2023-09-07	FY24-Q2 Post-earnings internal recap	AMA
2023-08-16	FY24-Q3 Quarterly Kickoff	AMA
2023-06-21	FY24-Q1 Results GitLab Assembly	AMA
2023-06-08	FY24-Q1 Post-Earnings Internal Recap	AMA
2023-05-17	FY24-Q2 Quarterly Kickoff	AMA
2023-03-15	FY23-Q4 Results GitLab Assembly	AMA
2023-02-28	FY24-Q1 Quarterly Kickoff	AMA
2022-12-08	FY23-Q3 Results GitLab Assembly	AMA
2022-11-16	FY23-Q4 Quarterly Kickoff	AMA
2022-09-22	FY23-Q2 Results GitLab Assembly	AMA

Quarterly Kickoff

The CEO has a Quarterly Kickoff in the first month of each quarter.

This is a forum to review our long-term goals, recognize progress made in the previous fiscal quarter, recap any significant recent events, and discuss our aims for the upcoming fiscal quarter. Material shared is internal only on Level Up.

The Quarterly Kickoff is followed by an AMA hosted by the CEO.

The CEO's Quarterly Kickoff Slides usually cover:

- Recap of GitLab's Mission/Vision/Strategy noting any updates made
- Review the previous quarter's OKRs, scores, and important details
- Sharing of this new quarter's OKRs
- Marathon Slide (as needed)

The Quarterly Kickoff is an Office of the CEO initiative.

A member of the Office of the CEO is the DRI, but we coordinate with Internal Comms, Legal, and the EBA team to get the slides prepared, recorded, shared, and AMA scheduled; following the Quarterly Kickoff Planning template (internal). Please make a copy of this template for the respective Quarterly Kickoff.

Timeline for the Quarterly Kickoff

Week relative to quarter	Task
----- ----	
-4.5	Pick the date for the next kickoff. See schedule for tentative dates. The preferred date to share the video is on the Monday of the second full week of the quarter. Work with internal comms to validate this date and schedule an AMA the following Wednesday with the appropriate invite list. The goal is to have as many E-Group members as possible participate.
-4	Begin preparations, including slides and internal comms announcement.

- | -3 | Schedule three review/recording sessions with the CEO. The first session is a review only and in the last week of the quarter. The two review/recording sessions should follow quarter close to ensure any needed information is included in the deck. |
- | -2 | Ensure time is scheduled on the chosen date for the CEO to send the comms. |
- | +2 | Ensure comms has gone out. Attend the AMA which follows. |

Schedule for remaining FY25 and FY26 Quarterly Kickoffs {schedule}

Note: This schedule is subject to change based on the CEO's availability

- 1. FY25-Q4: Review/Record 2024-11-04 and 2024-11-06. Share the video on 2024-11-11. AMA on 2024-11-13.
- 1. FY26-Q1: Review/Record 2025-02-03 and 2025-02-05. Share the video on 2025-02-10. AMA on 2025-02-12.
- 1. FY26-Q2: Review/Record 2025-05-03 and 2025-05-05. Share the video on 2025-05-12. AMA on 2025-05-14.
- 1. FY26-Q3: Review/Record 2025-08-04 and 2025-08-06. Share the video on 2025-08-11. AMA on 2025-08-13.
- 1. FY26-Q4: Review/Record 2025-11-03 and 2025-11-05. Share the video on 2025-11-10. AMA on 2025-11-12.

Zoom recording settings

Use the following settings in Zoom to record. It is best for the recorder to own the Zoom link in the invite otherwise the recorder needs to be granted permission.

- 1. Pin the CEO
- 1. Change View to Speaker
- 1. Enable Hide Self View
- 1. Enable Hide Non-video participants
- 1. Ask everyone except the CEO to mute their audio/video
- 1. Click Record -> Record on this Computer

Post-Earnings Recap & AMA

Held the week of our quarterly Earnings Call, the Post-Earnings Recap & AMA is an opportunity for team members to ask questions related to our Financial Results.

For more information about our quarterly Earnings process, visit the Investor Relations Handbook page.

The Post-Earnings Recap & AMA is a Finance initiative.

GitLab Assembly

GitLab Assembly is our quarterly all-company meeting and is an opportunity for team members to hear from leaders and teams across the company.

To learn more about GitLab Assembly, visit the Assembly section of the People Communications &

team member engagement Handbook page.

Assembly is a People Communications & Engagement initiative.

SECTION: company/history.md

A brief history of GitLab

2023: Leader in First DevOps Magic Quadrant

GitLab succeeded in its first 10 year vision of creating a DevOps Platform category. This became official when Gartner® introduced its first Gartner® Magic Quadrant for DevOps Platforms category. It recognized GitLab as a Leader · positioned highest on the Ability to Execute axis. We believe Gartner naming GitLab a Leader in the Magic Quadrant for DevOps Platforms is recognition of our success in both creating a comprehensive software development and delivery platform, and our role in helping mature the DevOps Platform category.

In the Third Quarter of Fiscal Year 2024, GitLab achieved non-GAAP operating profits for the first time. Brian Robins, GitLab chief financial officer, stated "I am pleased to share that we had our first quarter of non-GAAP operating profit while continuing to invest in key product areas including security, compliance, AI, and Enterprise Agile Planning."

2021: 10 Years of GitLab

This year we celebrated 10 years of GitLab, marking a decade since the first commit was made! Our focus on community contributions remained strong, averaging more than 650 code contributions a month from over 2500 wider community contributors. Thanks to our DevOps Platform, we grew to more than 1 million active license users and 30+ million estimated registered users as of August 2021. GitLab, the company, grew to over 1400 team members in 65 countries and regions around the world. We continued to support and educate businesses about the benefits of remote work by leading more than 60 collaborative remote work discussions with companies, VCs and universities since the beginning of the pandemic.

On October 14, 2021, GitLab Inc. became a publicly traded company on the Nasdaq Global Market (NASDAQ: GTLB).

Watch the video of GitLab's Listing Day

{{< vimeo 650088717 >}}

2020: The world's largest all-remote company

With over 1,200 team members in more than 65 countries, we believe we were the world's largest all-remote company prior to the COVID-19 pandemic. Every single team member is remote, with no central headquarters and no company-owned offices anywhere in the world. GitLab has raised \$426M to date.

2019: Contribute

Haydn Mackay delivered a wonderful keynote at GitLab Contribute in New Orleans detailing GitLab's history. As one of GitLab's earliest employees and an inspiration for GitLab's all-remote culture, Haydn provided a uniquely comprehensive view of GitLab's evolution.

2017: GitLab Storytime

A team member at GitLab interviewed the first five team members from GitLab to hear stories from the first years. In Storytime Part 1 the team talks about hiring its first team member, learning to iterate, thoughts of shutting down, Y Combinator, and how the values were created. In Storytime Part 2, we hear some hilarious stories of a surprise bachelor party, a competitor's offer to talk, a presentation that involved a lab coat and safety goggles, the first GitLab summit, and experiences at the Mountain View House.

2016: Growth

In 2016 the number of people that contributed to GitLab grew to more than 1000. More than 100,000 organizations and millions of users are using GitLab. Our team grew with 100 people to more than 140. In September we announce our master plan and raising \$20m in our B round of financing.

2015: Y Combinator

In the very start of 2015, almost the entire GitLab team flew over to Silicon Valley to participate in Y Combinator.

We became much more comfortable with a much faster pace, and it changed the way we thought about what we could achieve in a short timeframe. If we think something takes too long, we need to change our idea of what we can accomplish. There is always an opportunity to do something smaller and imperfect but that still makes a difference.

It was essential to the trajectory we've set. We never thought we could beat our competitors, but we had big ambitions and knew we had a great product and would continue to iterate and improve on that product, which we still do today.

We graduated in March of 2015 and had 9 people on our team. The GitLab Handbook was added to the website repository.

2014: GitLab was incorporated

In 2014 GitLab was officially incorporated as a limited liability corporation. GitLab released a new version every month on the 22nd, just as every year before and after. The first release of the year at January 22nd: GitLab 6.5. At the end of 2014, December 2014, GitLab 7.6 was released. In the end of that year we submitted our application to Y Combinator.

2013: "I want to work on GitLab full time"

Large organizations running GitLab asked Sid to add features that they needed. At the same time Dmitry tweeted out to the world that he wanted to work on GitLab full time. Sid and Dmitry teamed up and introduced GitLab Enterprise Edition with the features asked for

by larger organizations. Sid authored the initial commit on GitLab's website repository.

2012: GitLab.com

Sid saw GitLab for the first time and thought it was natural that a collaboration tool for programmers was open source so you could contribute to it.

Being a Ruby programmer he checked out the source code and was impressed with the code quality of GitLab after more than 300 contributions in the first year.

He asked Hacker News if they were interested in using GitLab.com and hundreds of people signed up for the beta.

In November 2012, Dmitriy made the first version of GitLab CI.

2011: Start of GitLab

GitLab's co-founder Dmitriy Zaporozhets needed a great tool to collaborate with his team. He wanted something efficient and enjoyable so he could focus on his work, not the tools. He created GitLab from his house in Ukraine. It was a house without running water but Dmitriy perceived not having a great collaboration tool as a bigger problem than his daily trip to the communal well.

So together with Valeriy Sizov, he started to build GitLab as a solution for this. This commit was the very start of GitLab on October 8, 2011.

The GitLab name was inspired by GitWeb and other git products.

When did we know that GitLab would work?

As GitLab's co-founder, Sid, puts it: it was iterative. The first time was when he saw GitLab and how easy it made collaboration. The second time was when he first made a post about it on Hacker News, and it didn't trend at first, so he left his computer to go make pancakes. But he had his phone with him, and his post started to get tons of comments and was featured on the home page. He asked his wife to take over making the pancakes for a few minutes, but he never came back because he spent the rest of the day answering questions about GitLab. Another time was when GitLab got into Y Combinator.

How did GitLab become an all-remote company?

{{< youtube "jdN5mj5ieLk?start=14" >}}

As part of a Harvard Business School case study interview, GitLab co-founder Sid Sijbrandij spoke with Professor Prithwiraj Choudhury regarding the company's early days and how he thought about all-remote.

> The first employee of the company was based in Serbia. It wasn't practical to bring him to The Netherlands, and it wasn't practical for me to go to Serbia, so that was remote.

>

> Then, we hired Dmitriy [Zaporozhets] in the Ukraine, so it wasn't practical [for him to come to The Netherlands] either.

>

> Then, I hired a couple of people in The Netherlands. It was practical for them to come · I

had an extra desk in my home · but by day three or four they stopped showing up. They were online, so we just continued working.

>

> I thought, 'OK, I'm going to tell them to show up tomorrow.' I then thought, 'Well, that's 1.5 hours of extra time spent commuting. Are we going to get 1.5 more hours of efficiency? Probably not.'

>

> I continued to hire people in The Netherlands, and continually they stopped showing up after a couple of days.

>

> Then, we did Y Combinator and almost all of the company lived in the same house. That was effective and intense. There is something to be said if you're one team of people and you can be in the same room together, and you have to move quickly, I'm supportive of doing that in-person.

>

> Afterwards, everyone went back home because they were away from the people they cared most about. Our Y Combinator coaches said, 'Look, this whole remote thing, it kind of works for engineering, but it doesn't work for other functions, so consider getting an office.'

>

> I thought that was good advice. You see, a typical flaw of a technical, product-focused CEO [like me] is that they think they can reinvent management. I believed in middle management, I believed in sales, and I thought: 'Let's not fall into that same trap by being adamant about having to be remote.'

>

> So, we got an office in San Francisco. It housed 15 people. The first person to show up there was our sales person, who had been with the company for a while. He stopped coming after a couple of days, and the same pattern continued. People came in a few days, then stopped coming.

>

> It was because we were so used to using systems correctly, and using a remote work style. We used Slack, video calls, Google Docs, GitLab Issues, GitLab merge requests · we were just used to that way of working.

>

> A few times it became contentious · mostly on executive hiring. Then, they come in and talk to the other executives, where they'd hear 'This is my first remote company as well, but I have an easier time reaching people here than at my previous job. People are super good at replying to messages and reading things here.'

>

> We didn't think remote would work for sales development representatives. These people are fresh out of school, they hear a lot of 'no' · it's a tough job, and they typically need the camaraderie of being together. Then, we found a couple of great SDRs in Utah and thought, 'We aren't going to make them move.'

>

> At a certain point, we decided: 'OK, this works. Almost nobody in the company wants to come to the office because it's a waste of time.'

>

> The worst thing you can do is have a hybrid company, where some people are at the office using certain communication styles, while others are remote using different communication styles. That leads to a lot of inefficiency.

>

> When we decided to become remote, our investors were worried about it. They said, 'Look, there are very few remote companies at scale.' At the time, there was WordPress and InVision.

>

> We said, 'OK, we'll be pragmatic. As soon as we have a big breakdown in the leadership team or something, we'll reconsider.'

>

> That did not happen. We said, 'We're pretty sure this scales a lot better. We're actually able to grow faster and have less disconnect amongst the leadership team than in other companies.'

Moving to the topic of investors and their perception of remote companies, Sid added the following.

> [Early investors] were skeptical of this model. They've turned from skeptics into advocates. They see our ability to hire outpacing their portfolio companies. They see our ability to retain people and our cost structure being much better.

>

> They're now actually starting to focus on companies which are all-remote, because they think it is a big competitive advantage.

Value Origin stories

GitLab's six core values are · Collaboration, · Results , · Efficiency, · Diversity, Inclusion & Belonging, · Iteration, and · Transparency, and together they spell the CREDIT we give each other by assuming good intent. In the following recordings, GitLab's co-founder, Sid Sijbrandij, shares stories around each values origination and importance to GitLab.

Collaboration

"We have assume positive intent in our CREDIT value."

{{< youtube "rCbEzjfaY0w" >}}

Results

"If you get good results you have leverage to invest and do everything else."

{{< youtube "OYQyuZDdrUE" >}}

Efficiency

"We get a lot done. We don't tolerate ineffectiveness."

{{< youtube "d5UATqiFbDw" >}}

Diversity, Inclusion & Belonging

"We want to have a company with many people in it--especially when they are different from us."

{{< youtube "ovbciPq9x4" >}}

Iteration

"The key to going fast is not about being super ambitious with planning more hours or having a big idea--but having the big idea and cutting that down to what you can ship quickly."

{{< youtube "OTCICuXpbhQ" >}}

Transparency

"Most of the time when a company starts commercializing the open source community, the wider community, fades away into the background. We want to prevent that. We want people to feel empowered."

{{< youtube "HJhIL6Oozq8" >}}

{{% include "includes/take-gitlab-for-a-spin.md" %}}

SECTION: company/inspired-by-gitlab.md

Which companies can be listed here?

Any company that has been inspired by GitLab's culture and/or by any part of our handbook can be listed here.

Transparency is one of GitLab's values, and so we encourage you and your company to read our handbook and use the parts that make sense to your business, or even adapt it to your context.

With that, we want to know what on GitLab's culture or on GitLab's handbook inspired you, and how are you and your company using it to the benefit your business?

To be listed in this page, open an issue with the following information:

Title: Add company XYZ on Inspired by GitLab handbook page / Update company XYX on Inspired by GitLab handbook page

Description: Tells us what exactly was the inspiration, with a link to the handbook page so that others can have a look, and maybe get inspired as well. Optionally, send us your company's website URL so that we can link to it.

Label: handbook

Or, if you feel comfortable with making the change yourself, submit a merge request, and we will be happy to review and have it merged as soon as possible. Don't forget to add the label 'handbook'.

Companies that have been inspired by GitLab

In this section we list the companies that have been inspired by GitLab with the links to the

handbook pages that inspired them.

1. Facebook

- "In 2019, before the pandemic, tech company GitLab hired Darren Murph to be its head of remote, helping manage the employee experience for its entirely remote workforce. Since the pandemic, Murph has been advising other companies on designing successful remote working arrangements, including Facebook."

1. Dropbox

- "What GitLab-proven techniques can you apply to your own organizational transformation? We refined them into a 1-2-3 set of high-level practices applicable to both all-remote and (more likely) hybrid companies who seek to succeed in a work-from-home world."

1. City of Boston

- "Just watched your live stream about All-Remote and wanted to chime in. I've been stealing pages out of the GitLab handbook heavily for @CityOfBoston. Especially the pages on communication, meetings, and roles which are infinitely important in a remote setting."

1. Remote

- Remote handles international payroll, benefits, taxes, and compliance for businesses big and small. It was founded by a former GitLab team member and uses a public handbook.

1. BNP Paribas

- "Thanks Flexjob and GitLab for your time! Learning how to work efficiently on [all-remote] was really inspiring. We've learned a lot from your daily practices."

1. Upwork

- "Skip the workacation and take the vacation! I totally +1 to GitLab's Darren M.'s comment that committing to our team's sanity starts with each of us creating boundaries, particularly in senior leadership. I have actively tried to publicize within my company to promote others to take time off, too."

1. Almanac

- "The Almanac team handbook is our company's operating system: a central doc repository of the principles, structures, and systems we use to run the company."

1. Tangram Visions

- "In particular, our engineering team has placed GitLab at the core of our remote workflow, because it reinforces our values and perspectives around working well remotely."

1. Fellow.app

- "Documentation and a 'single source of truth' for remote teams is key."

1. OpenAI

- Sam Altman, CEO of OpenAI, discusses plans to consider a CEO Shadow program based on GitLab's pioneering approach to the concept.

1. Doist

- This all-remote company launched Twist, a team communications app. In a series of Remote Work Guides, Doist cites GitLab in sharing practices around all-remote hiring and management, as well as mastering asynchronous communication.

1. Joy Labs

- This all-remote company is developing communication software, including Memo. GitLab's intentional approach to informal communication was used in building Joy Labs' company culture.

1. Veamly

- Veamly is a remote-first software firm. CEO Emna G. was inspired GitLab's documented approach to building company culture, and shared elements that she is implementing in a GitLab Unfiltered Pick Your Brain video.

1. ProxyCrawl

- At ProxyCrawl we are a completely remote company with employees all around the world

working from home, co-working spaces, coffee shops, parks, etc. All our products have been created by our remote team. We have faced many of the issues of a worldwide remote team and GitLab handbook has helped us and inspired us to be a greater team. Special mentions to communication and all-remote pages.

1. Hubstaff

- "The open source GitLab handbook is why I'm a successful remote worker and leader after a 13 year career in education."

1. Clearbit

- "As the COVID headwinds continue to push back against a full reopening, now is a good time for CEOs to embrace remote work · and discover how it can make their teams even more effective."

1. Tackle

- "[The GitLab all-remote guide] is an amazing resource when you are working through building a remote company. We use it regularly at Tackle. Thanks GitLab for sharing your guide with the community."

1. Gable

- "Remote work thrives most when teams focus on async communication and that's just what we do, guided by amazing examples from GitLab, Doist, and Buffer. Our team is not expected to answer emails or Slack chats immediately."

1. Botmock

- "[GitLab] literally wrote the manifesto on remote work; for this our team will be forever grateful."

1. Aimtal

- "All of this, especially THIS - 'Remote isn't the future of work; it's the future of living.' We're adopting many of GitLab's remote work practices and processes at Aimtal. Many thanks to their team for openly sharing their knowledge and insights!"

1. AsyncGo

- "A company handbook that everyone edits together is such a superpower, and I've never seen anyone do it better than GitLab. It was the very first thing I brought to my next job because it is the foundation for so much other goodness."

1. Vowel

- "It's amazing what GitLab, Buffer, and Remote have done for the rest of the world by open sourcing how they operate remotely. I am convinced that in 10 years, we'll look back at these documents as a crucial step in the evolution of Remote Work."

1. Mighty

- "I've stolen this from GitLab, but I think you have to ensure a consistent experience where the people in an office aren't treated specially and you provide a remote-first culture."

1. Journal

- "We couldn't have created the persona without examples from @gitlab's handbook."

1. Aula

- "I started out skeptical about remote work. My fears were vague, like 'You can't build a strong company culture if you don't see each other.' Now, having built a remote company for two years, I'm unlikely to work from an office ever again GitLab's journey inspired our leap of faith to tear up our London office lease to embrace remote work."

1. Spark'n

- "Spending a lot of time processing GitLab's rather amazing remote work manifesto/guidebook for use at Spark'n. Really gel with the 100% remote commit for the modern workplace. It's very now and the future. · Unreal @darrenmurph and team. · "

1. LogDNA

- "Remote-first, remote-biased... inspired by GitLab and other leaders. It started with a

great conversation with GitLab CMO Todd Barr who taught me about the remote-first approach and GitLab Remote Playbook. That helped reinforce how LogDNA creates support structures for remote work and grows its vibrant, values-driven culture."

1. AvenueHQ

- "GitLab's approach to [values-driven hiring resonated with what we do at AvenueHQ. It was a real lightbulb moment hearing about how planned the 'serendipity' we experience in the office actually is. It made me feel that] we can [recreate that in a distributed environment!]"

1. Axya

- "Axya · GitLab's remote culture! The GitLab platform is not the only thing we love about GitLab, but also their remote culture. As a remote-first SaaS company, Axya is heavily inspired by the likes of GitLab and Automattic."

1. Assured Information Security

- "As a predominantly on-premise organization, Assured Information Security is sitting on the shoulder of giants by adapting GitLab communication practices and using GitLab technology. The care and expertise is apparent in the GitLab company values, handbook, community, and product, which has allowed us to rapidly adopt a new way of doing business and trust we are on a proven path."

1. Matter IP

- "GitLab are real leaders in remote working, which is something essential to our business model but that we felt out of our depth on. The Remote Playbook has been a great resource for us to make sure we approach this in a way that leads to success."

1. OpenNebula

- "Inspired by GitLab and its all-remote movement, we are adopting a fully distributed work policy to improve talent recruitment and retention, employee wellness, and long-term flexibility, adaptability, and scalability. We are starting a journey to build remote fluency in our organization. In the following months, we will be implementing new operational processes to help our people and organization embrace remote work and the future of living."

1. Yembo

- "We are building our own handbook inspired by GitLab. Thank you to the entire GitLab team for open sourcing so much information."

1. Synura

- "Founded by a former GitLab employee, Synura is a video collaboration app that follows most GitLab remote work practices including a public handbook."

1. Gozynta

- "We were inspired by GitLab to start Gozynta as a remote-first company in 2018. This model has given us the flexibility to build a great team spread across 5 different countries, and has permitted our founders to move to a new country themselves (something they never imagined being able to do before). We use GitLab internally to manage our development team, and keep coming back to the GitLab Handbook for additional inspiration on how to run our company better. Thanks GitLab!"

Do you know of other companies that were inspired by GitLab but are not listed here?

Let us know by opening an issue to include them in this page, with the company's name and their website so that we can contact them and list their experience here as well, to inspire others. Don't forget to add the label 'handbook'.

SECTION: company/kpis.md

What are KPIs

Every part of GitLab has Key Performance Indicators (KPIs) linked to the company OKRs. Avoid the term metric where we can be more explicit.

Use KPI instead.

A function's KPIs are owned by the respective member of e-group.

A function may have many performance indicators (PIs) they track and not all of them will be KPIs.

KPIs should be a subset of PIs and used to indicate the most important PIs to be surfaced to leadership.

The KPI definition should be in the most relevant part of the handbook which is organized by function and results.

In the definition, it should mention what the canonical source is for this indicator.

Where there are formulas, include those as well.

Goals related to KPIs should co-exist with the definition.

For example, "Wider community contributions per release" should be in the Developer Relations part of the handbook and "Average days to hire" should be in the Talent Acquisition part of the handbook.

KPI Index

Legend

The icons below are relevant for Phase 1 and can be assigned by anyone at GitLab.

- KPI is operational, public, and embedded in the GitLab Handbook next to the definition.
- KPI is operational, links to another system because the KPI is internal or can't be embedded in the GitLab Handbook yet.
- KPI is operational, links to a limited access system.
- KPI is WIP: work in progress and estimated to be operational within a month. Should include a link to an issue.
- KPI is unlikely to be operationalized in the near term.

GitLab KPIs

GitLab's North Star metric is run-rate revenue. In addition, there are other 10 other top KPIs.

GitLab KPIs are duplicates of goals of the reports further down this page.

GitLab KPIs are the 10 most important indicators of company performance, and the most important KPI is Net ARR.

We review these at each quarterly meeting of the Board of Directors.

These KPIs are determined by a combination of their stand alone importance to the company and the amount of management focus devoted to improving the metric.

1. Revenue vs. plan (lagging)

1. R&D Overall MR Rate (leading)
1. Estimated Combined Monthly Active Users (CMAU) (leading)
1. Net New Business Pipeline Created (\$s) · (leading)
1. Pipeline coverage start of quarter stage 3+ (leading)
1. Percent of Ramped Reps at or Above Quota (lagging)
1. Net Retention (lagging)
1. Gross Retention (lagging)
1. 12 Month Team Member Voluntary Retention (lagging)
1. Unique Wider Community Contributors per Month (lagging)

Office of the CEO KPIs

{{< kpi "Office of the CEO" >}}

Sales KPIs

Sales KPIs are Not Public and documented in the Internal handbook.

{{< kpi "Sales" >}}

Marketing KPIs

{{< kpi "Marketing" >}}

Developer Relations Department KPIs

{{< kpi "Developer Relations Department" >}}

People Group KPIs

People Success KPIs

{{< kpi "People Success" >}}

Finance KPIs

Finance Team KPIs - Reported in Key Review

{{< kpi "Finance Team" >}}

Product KPIs

GitLab team members can access and update all Product performance indicators within the internal handbook via Okta > GitLab Internal Handbook

Engineering KPIs

{{< kpi "Engineering Function" >}}

Customer Support Department KPIs

{{< kpi "Customer Support Department" >}}

Development Department KPIs

{{< kpi "Development Department" >}}

Infrastructure Department KPIs

{{< kpi "Infrastructure Department" >}}

UX Department KPIs

{{< kpi "UX Department" >}}

Satisfaction

We do satisfaction scope on a scale of 1 to 5 how satisfied people are with the experience. We don't use NPS since that cuts off certain scores and we want to preserve fidelity. We have the following abbreviation letter before SAT, please don't use SAT without letter before to specify it:

- C = unused since customer is ambiguous (can mean product or support, not all users are customers)
- E = unused since employee is used by other companies but not by us
- I = Interviewee (would you recommend applying here)
- L = Leadership (as an executive with dedicated administrative support, how is your executive administrative support received)
- O = Onboarding (how was your onboarding experience)
- P = Product (would you recommend GitLab the product)
- S = Support (would you recommend our support followup)
- T = Team-members (would you recommend working here)

Retention

Since we track retention in a lot of ways, we should never refer to just "Retention" without indicating what kind of retention.

We track:

- Net Retention
- Gross Retention
- User Retention
- Team Member Retention

Layers of KPIs

We have KPIs at many different layers.

KPIs can only exist at the Company (e.g. GitLab) layer if it exists at the functional layer. In other words, GitLab KPIs are duplicates of KPIs of the executives. Not all functional KPIs are GitLab KPIs but all GitLab KPIs are functional KPIs.

As GitLab grows, this will also be true throughout the layers.
Not all departmental KPIs will be functional KPIs but all functional KPIs will be department KPIs.
This will cascade throughout the organization, as all job families will have performance indicators associated with them.

The KPI Index captures the company, functional, and departmental KPIs since these are the three highest layers.

The only exception to this is where the filter on a KPI may change.
For example, the GitLab KPI may be "Hires vs Plan" but the Engineering KPI may be "Engineering Hires vs Plan".
The logic is the same, but the filter changes.

Parts of a KPI

A KPI or metric consists of multiple things:

1. Definition: What is the data source? How is it calculated? What fields are included? What caveats are considered? Why is it chosen?

- Note: Please see Infrastructure Hosting Cost per MAU as an example.

1. Target: What we strive to be above, e.g. ARR has a target

1. Cap: What we strive to be below, e.g. Turnover has a cap

1. Job family: link to job families with this as a performance indicator

1. Plan: what we have in our yearly plan

1. Commit: the most negative it will be

1. 50/50: the median estimate, 50% chance of being lower and higher

1. Best case: the most positive it will be

1. Forecast: what we use in our rolling 4 quarter forecast

1. Actual: what the number is

What is public?

In the doc 'GitLab Metrics at IPO' are the KPIs that we may share publicly.

All KPIs have a public definition, goal, and job family links.

The actual performance and various estimates can be:

1. Live reported

1. Quarterly reported

1. Private

SECTION: company/mission.md

Mission

It is GitLab's mission to enable everyone to contribute to and co-create the software that powers our world.

There are three ways you can contribute and co-create:

1. Everyone can contribute with GitLab

1. Everyone can contribute to and co-create with GitLab, the application

1. Everyone can contribute to GitLab, the company

Everyone can contribute with GitLab{contribute-with-gitlab}

To ensure that everyone can contribute with GitLab we allow anyone to create a proposal, at any time, without setup, and with confidence. Let's analyze that sentence a bit.

- Anyone: Every person in the world should be able to afford great DevSecOps software.

GitLab.com has free private repos and CI runners and GitLab CE is free as in speech and as in beer. But open source is more than a license, that is why we are a good steward of GitLab CE and keep both GitLab CE and EE open to inspection, modifications, enhancements, and suggestions.

- Create: It is a single application based on convention over configuration.

- Proposal: With Git, if you can read it, you can fork it to create a proposal.

- At any time: You can work concurrently with other people, without having to wait for permission or approval from others.

- Without setup: You can make something without installing or configuring for hours with our web IDE and Auto DevSecOps.

- With confidence: Reduce the risk of a flawed proposal with review apps, CI/CD, code quality, security scans, performance testing, and monitoring.

Everyone can contribute to and co-create with GitLab, the application{contribute-to-gitlab-application}

We actively welcome contributors to enable everyone to contribute to and co-create with GitLab, the application. When everyone can contribute and co-create, users become contributors and we greatly

increase the rate of innovation to benefit customers and users. There is also an open dialogue between GitLab and our customers, partners, and the community so that we can also better identify what they need. That way we can not only build a solution for them, but bring that solution to the world.

We think that it is logical that our collaboration tools are a collaborative work themselves. More than 3,000 people from the wider community have contributed to GitLab to make that a reality.

We do this by having quality code, tests, documentation, popular frameworks, and offering a comprehensive GitLab Development Kit and a dedicated GitLab Design System.

We use GitLab at GitLab Inc., we dogfood

it and make it a tool we continue to love. We celebrate contributions by recognizing a Most Valuable Person (MVP) every month.

We allow everyone to anticipate, propose, discuss, and contribute features by having everything on

a public issue tracker. We ship a new version every month so contributions and feedback are visible fast. To contribute to open source software, people

must be empowered to learn programming.

That is why we sponsor initiatives such as Rails Girls.

There are a few significant, but often overlooked, nuances of the enabling everyone to contribute to GitLab, the application mantra:

- While collaboration is a core value of GitLab, over collaborating tends to involve team members unnecessarily, leading to consensus-based decision making, and ultimately slowing the pace of improvement in the GitLab application. Consider doing it yourself, creating a merge request, and facilitating a discussion on the solution.
- For valuable features in line with our product philosophy, that do not yet exist within the application, don't worry about UX having a world class design before shipping. While we must be good stewards of maintaining a quality product, we also believe in rapid iteration to add polish and depth after an MVC is created.
- Prefer creating merge requests ahead of issues in order to suggest a tangible change to facilitate collaboration, driving conversation to the recommended implementation.
- Contributors should feel free to create what they need in GitLab. If quality engineering requires charting features, for example, which would normally be implemented out of another team, they should feel empowered to prioritize their own time to focus on this aspect of the application.
- GitLab maintainers, developers, and Product Managers should be viewed as coaches for contributions, independent of source. While there are contributions that may not get merged as-is (such as copy/paste of EE code into the CE code base or features that aren't aligned with product philosophy), the goal is to coach contributors to contribute in ways that are cohesive to the rest of the application.

A group discussion reiterating the importance of everyone being able to contribute:

{{< youtube "I374J98iOmk?t=675" >}}

Everyone can contribute to GitLab, the company{contribute-to-gitlab-company}

To enable everyone to contribute to GitLab, the company we have open business processes. This allows all team members to suggest improvements to our handbook. We hire remotely so our team members can be judged on results, not presence in an office. We engage on social media platforms and in our blog post comments. And we strive to take decisions guided by our values.

Everyone can contribute to about.gitlab.com

We welcome all contributors in the www.gitlab.com project so that everyone can contribute to about.gitlab.com. GitLab uses about.gitlab.com to share our expertise with the world and believe we can build even greater levels of trust with contributions from our team and community. We strive to provide a great experience for our existing and new community members by reviewing changes and integrating the contributions into our regularly planned updates.

Cadence and Alignment

Our Mission is on a 30 year cadence.

Purpose

Our purpose is to help people increase their lifetime earnings through training, access to opportunities, and the DevSecOps platform.

Our mission is the way we realize our purpose. By enabling everyone to contribute to and co-create the software that powers our world, we increase access for people to be creators. With more contributors and more creators, we increase both the volume and velocity of innovation. More innovation drives economic progress that benefits consumers, businesses, and the economy as a whole. As a result, innovation both directly and indirectly increases the total volume of available opportunities and average value of each individual opportunity.

Access to a broader set of more valuable opportunities ultimately increases people's lifetime earnings.

Our purpose is on the same 30 year cadence as our mission. Our purpose informs our mission, which directly or indirectly informs the rest of the items in our cadence. As a result, progress for the items on our cadence page creates progress for both our mission and our purpose.

Vision

Our mission is the inspiration for our vision. Our vision is on a 10 year cadence.

Values

Our mission guides our path, and our values are the principles we live along this path.

Customer acceptance

We firmly adhere to laws including trade compliance laws -- see the GitLab Code of Business Conduct and Ethics, in countries where we do business, and welcome everyone abiding by those legal restrictions to be customers of GitLab. In some circumstances, we may opt to not work with particular organizations, on a case-by-case basis. Some reasons we may choose not to work with certain entities include, but are not limited to:

1. Engaging in illegal, unlawful behavior.
1. Making derogatory statements or threats toward anyone in our community.
1. Encouraging violence or discrimination against legally protected groups.

This policy is in alignment with our mission, contributor and employee code-of-conduct and company values. Here are some links that may give you some background at how we arrived at this customer acceptance policy:

- Our mission is to "enable everyone to contribute to and co-create the software that powers our world." This mission is in alignment with our open source roots and the MIT license our open source software is subject to. The MIT License is a free software license that allows users the freedom to run the program as they wish, for any purpose.
- GitLab has a contributor code of conduct for how to contribute to GitLab, but there are no restrictions on who can contribute to GitLab. We desire that everyone can contribute, as long as they abide by the code of conduct.
- GitLab has a set of values for how GitLab team members strive to conduct themselves. We don't

expect all companies to value collaboration, results, efficiency, diversity, inclusion and transparency in the same way we do. As an open company, "everyone can contribute" is our default and transparency is our check and balance. Transparency means our handbook, issues, merge requests and product roadmap are online for everyone to see and contribute to.

- Related topic: At GitLab, we want to avoid an environment where people feel alienated for their religious or political opinions. Therefore, we encourage GitLab team members to refrain from taking positions on specific religious or political issues in public company forums (such as on the GitLab Contribute stage or Slack channels) because it is easy to alienate people that may have a minority opinion. It is acceptable to bring up these topics in social contexts such as coffee chats and real-life meetups with other coworkers, b